

Elisa Jácome

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Academic Positions

Assistant Professor of Economics, Northwestern University, 2022–
Postdoctoral Fellow, SIEPR, Stanford University, 2021–2022

Affiliations

Faculty Research Fellow, National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER)
Faculty Fellow, Institute for Policy Research, Northwestern University
Visiting Scholar, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago
Faculty Affiliate, Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Princeton University, 2015–2021
M.A. in Economics, Princeton University, 2017
B.S. in International Economics (*summa cum laude*), Georgetown University, 2009–2013

Research Fields

Primary	Labor economics, public economics
Secondary	Economic history, economics of crime, health economics

Peer-reviewed Publications

“Mobility for All: Representative Intergenerational Mobility Estimates over the 20th Century”
with Ilyana Kuziemko and Suresh Naidu,
Journal of Political Economy, Vol. 133. 2025.

“Law-Abiding Immigrants: The Incarceration Gap Between Immigrants and the US-born, 1870–2020”
with Ran Abramitzky, Leah Boustan, Santiago Pérez, and Juan David Torres,
American Economic Review: Insights, Vol. 6. 2024 (Lead Article).

“Intergenerational Mobility of Immigrants in the US over Two Centuries”
with Ran Abramitzky, Leah Boustan, and Santiago Pérez,
American Economic Review 111(2): 580–608. 2021.

“The Effect of Immigration Enforcement on Crime Reporting: Evidence from Dallas.”
Journal of Urban Economics, Vol. 128. 2022.

Working Papers

“Community Engagement and Public Safety: Evidence from Crime Enforcement Targeting Immigrants”
with Felipe Gonçalves and Emily Weisburst (NBER WP #32109)
Conditionally accepted at *American Economic Review*

“Mental Health and Criminal Involvement: Evidence from Losing Medicaid Eligibility”

Intergenerational Mobility of Immigrants in 15 Destination Countries

with Leah Boustan, Mathias Fjællegaard Jensen, Ran Abramitzky, Alan Manning, Santiago Pérez, Analysis Watley, Adrian Adermon, Jaime Arellano-Bover, Olof Aslund, Marie Connolly, Nathan Deutscher, Anne C. Gielen, Yvonne Giesing, Yajna Govind, Martin Halla, Dominik Hangartner, Yuyan Jiang, Cecilia Karmel, Fanny Landaud, Lindsey Macmillan, Isabel Z. Martínez, Alberto Polo, Panu Poutvaara, Hillel Rapoport, Sara Roman, Kjell G. Salvanes, Shmuel San, Michael Siegenthaler, Louis Sirugue, Javier Soria Espín, Jan Stuhler, Giovanni L. Violante, Dinand Webbink, Andrea Weber, Jonathan Zhang, Angela Zheng, & Tom Zohar (NBER WP #33558)

Revisions requested at *American Economic Review*

“The Effect of Mass Incarceration on Black Women” (Resting Paper)

Professional Activities

Referee for *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *American Economic Review*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *American Economic Review: Insights*, *Journal of Urban Economics*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Journal of Human Resources*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Explorations in Economic History*, *The Journal of Law and Economics*, *Review of Economics of the Household*, *Economic Journal*, *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*, *The B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy*, *Journal of Quantitative Criminology*, *Eastern Economic Journal*, *Labour Economics*, *Crime, Law, and Social Change*, *World Development*

Program Committee Member, Society of Labor Economists Conference, 2026

Organizer, “Women in Empirical Microeconomics” Conference, 2024 and 2025

Organizer, “Interactions: Bringing Together Econometrics and Applied Microeconomics” Conference, 2023

Organizer, Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics (SITE) Migration Conference, 2022

U.S. Census Bureau Special Sworn Status, 2019–present

Transactional Records Access Clearinghouse (TRAC) Research Fellow, 2018–present

Becker Friedman Institute Price Theory Camp, 2019

Graduate Student Summit for Diversity in Economics, 2018

Grants, Awards, & Fellowships

Arnold Ventures Planning Grant (“Interventions to Support Domestic Violence Survivors in Cook County”), 2025

Upjohn Institute Early Career Research Award, 2025

Arnold Ventures Planning Grant (“The Criminal and Economic Impacts of an Arrest”), 2025

Malmsten Early Career Scholar (MECS), Department of Economics, University of Gothenburg, 2025–2027

Northwestern Provost Grants for Research in Humanities, Social Sciences and the Arts, 2024

Northwestern Institute for Policy Research Seed Grant, 2023

Russell Sage Foundation Grant, 2021–2023

UCLA Ziman Center for Real Estate Grant, 2020–2021

Fellowship of SPIA Scholars, 2019–2021

Marimar and Cristina Torres Prize for Best Third Year Paper, 2018

Paul & Daisy Soros Fellowship for New Americans Finalist, 2017

Princeton University Graduate Fellowship, 2015–2021

Industrial Relations Section Graduate Fellowship, 2015–2017

William F. Notz Medal for Economics, 2013

Phi Beta Kappa, 2013

Conferences & Invited Seminars

- 2026 Opportunity Insights, Oxford, London School of Economics, Society of Labor Economists Conference
- 2025 Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Princeton University Workshop on the Intergenerational Mobility of Immigrants
- 2024 ASSA, Northwestern IPR, Northwestern Law, MIT Applied Economics Seminar, UC Santa Barbara, Research Network on Intergenerational Mobility, NBER Labor Studies Program Spring Meeting, George Washington University, Duke University Applied Micro Jamboree
- 2023 ASSA (discussant), Notre Dame, McMaster, NBER Immigrants and the U.S. Economy Conference, Harvard Economics, Inter-American Development Bank, NBER Labor Studies Program Spring Meeting (discussant), University of Toronto's Bissell-Heyd Conference on Race, Equity and Public Policy, BFI-LSE Conference on the Economics of Crime and Justice, Princeton Industrial Relations Section Centenary Symposium, Women in Empirical Microeconomics Conference, Explorations in Economic History (discussant), Purdue, University of Illinois Chicago, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee
- 2022 ASSA, UC Merced, UC Berkeley, University of Chicago Becker Applied Economics, APPAM, MIT Applied Economics Seminar, BU/MIT/Harvard Health Economics Seminar, SITE Migration, Gothenburg, Stockholm SOFI, NYU Stern, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, UC Denver, Michigan, Yale
- 2021 NBER Health Care Meeting, NTA Conference, Iowa State University, Brookings Institution, NYU, Niskanen Center's Summer Panel Series, Policy Impacts Inaugural Conference, NBER Summer Institute, SIEPR Postdoctoral Fellows Conference, Northwestern University, Stanford University, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, University of Oxford, Yale School of Management, UC Santa Cruz, Chicago Harris, UCLA Anderson School of Management, University of Zurich, Cornell University, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, UC Berkeley, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, UT Austin, University of British Columbia, Institute for Fiscal Studies, Brown University, Duke University, U.S. Treasury
- 2019 Social Science History Association

Teaching Experience

Graduate Labor Economics, Northwestern Department of Economics, Spring Quarter, 2023–

Economic Writing and Stata Workshop Instructor, Undergraduate Junior Independent Work, 2017–2019

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Leah Boustan, Undergraduate Junior Independent Work, 2017–2018

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Martin Evans, Introduction to Econometrics, 2012–2013

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Carol Rogers, Principles of Macroeconomics, 2012

Calculus Tutor for Mathematics Department, 2010–2011

Guest Lecturer for:

Prof. Felipe Gonçalves' PhD Labor Economics course, UCLA, 2024

Prof. Heather Sarsons' PhD Labor Economics course, University of British Columbia, 2023–2025

Prof. Ran Abramitzky's PhD Economic History course, Stanford, 2022

Prof. Aaron Chalfin's Seminar in Criminal Justice course, University of Pennsylvania, 2021

Research Experience

Research Assistant for Prof. Ilyana Kuziemko, 2016–2017

Research Assistant for Profs. Katharine Abraham and Melissa Kearney, 2016

Policy Coordinator and Senior Research Assistant, The Hamilton Project, Brookings Institution, 2013–2015

Research Assistant, The World Bank Group, 2012

Other Publications

“Profiles of change: Employment, earnings, and occupations from 1990–2013” (with Melissa S. Kearney and Brad Hershbein). The Hamilton Project, 2015.

“Ten Economic Facts about Crime and Incarceration in the United States” (with Melissa S. Kearney, Benjamin H. Harris, and Lucie Parker). The Hamilton Project, 2014.

“A Dozen Facts about America's Struggling Lower-Middle Class” (with Melissa Kearney, Benjamin Harris, and Lucie Parker). The Hamilton Project, 2013.

Languages and Skills

Languages: Spanish (native), English (native), French (working proficiency)

Programming languages: Stata, Matlab, L^AT_EX, ArcGIS

Last updated: December 29, 2025